

CHANDRA X-RAY OBSERVATORY

Space telescope

The outer clouds of this dying star give it the name Cat's Eye Nebula

Chandra was named after Subrahmanyan Chandrasekhar, a 20th-century astrophysicist.

Chandra has shown that a cloud of multi-million degree gas surrounds the central star



Artist's impression of Chandra

Launched on 23 July 1999, the Chandra observatory studies X-rays – very high-energy radiation – from the distant Universe. It has discovered giant clouds of hot gas held together by mysterious dark matter, and has also examined streams of gas as they fall into black holes.

DATA FILE



SIZE: 19.5 m (64 ft) long



DATE OF LAUNCH: 23 July 1999



MISSION DURATION: Ongoing



SPACE AGENCY: NASA